

Lily Botha

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
Trauma-related memory processes
Emotion regulation
Social and interpersonal mechanisms of trauma recovery
Psychedelic-assisted interventions
Military and veteran mental health

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Psychology

Expected May 2026

WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- GPA: 3.69 | Dean's List

Study Abroad

Fall 2024

DANISH INSTITUTE FOR STUDY ABROAD (DIS) — COPENHAGEN, DENMARK

- Coursework in well-being psychology and the cognitive psychology of decision-making.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Summer 2025 – Present

EMOTIONAL ADAPTATION & PSYCHOPHYSIOLOGY LAB, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- PI: Christian Waugh, PhD
- Cleaned, analyzed, and visualized behavioral and survey data using R, Excel, and Qualtrics for a reinforcement-learning study.
- Developed custom R scripts to extract, reconstruct, and validate missing data from raw log files.
- Designed experimental visual stimuli in Adobe Photoshop; created a standardized protocol and trained research assistants to replicate stimuli.
- Administered affective working-memory protocols; maintained participant tracking logs and ensured accurate data upload.
- Monitored and administered surveys to large participant cohorts for an emotional reappraisal study.

Research Assistant

Spring 2024 – Present

GROWTH INITIATIVE LAB, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- PI: Eranda Jayawickreme, PhD
- Coded themes and quality-checked interview transcripts for a study on pluralism in Sri Lanka.
- Screened 5,900 articles for a meta-synthesis on post-traumatic growth and related psychosocial and mental health outcomes.
- Applied inclusion/exclusion criteria and maintained structured coding logs.

Research Assistant

Summer 2025 – Fall 2025

SCHOOL OF LAW, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- PI: Gregory Parks, JD, PhD
- Conducted systematic literature reviews on fraternities, race, and law to support book chapter development.
- Co-authored research memos synthesizing findings on bystander intervention and group cohesion.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tutor

Fall 2025 – Present

STUDENT-ATHLETE SERVICES, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- Provided one-on-one instruction in philosophy to first-year student-athletes.
- Supported study strategies, time management, and critical thinking; monitored academic progress.

Swim Instructor

Spring 2021 – Fall 2024; Summer 2025 – Present

LIFE TIME INC.; WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — ATLANTA, GA; WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- Designed individualized lesson plans and collaborated with clients and families to establish and meet goals.
- Coached youth swim teams; led practices and coordinated swim meets.
- Delivered adaptive instruction for individuals with autism, Down syndrome, cerebral palsy, and behavioral disabilities.
- Maintained a strong focus on safety while communicating effectively with clients, families, and staff.

Lifeguard

Spring 2020 – Fall 2024; Spring 2025
– Present

LIFE TIME INC.; WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY — ATLANTA, GA; WINSTON-SALEM, NC

- Responded to emergencies in accordance with established facility protocols.
- Managed member check-in and addressed patron questions with professionalism.

Aquatics Supervisor

Summer 2024 – Fall 2024

LIFE TIME INC. — ATLANTA, GA

- Supervised and trained 40+ lifeguards and swim instructors.
- Coordinated staff scheduling and oversaw daily operations across multiple pool decks.

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Psychopharmacology
Applied Data Science for Psychologists
Research Methods in Psychology
Statistics
Social-Affective Neuroscience
Psychology of the Military
Abnormal Psychology
Research in Cognitive Psychology
Research in Judgment and Decision-Making
Contemporary Issues in Psychology
Personality Psychology
Psychology of Well-Being
Philosophy & Psychology
Philosophy of Human Nature

SKILLS

Research

HUMAN SUBJECTS RESEARCH; IRB PROTOCOLS; CITI CERTIFICATION; PARTICIPANT TRACKING; PROTOCOL ADMINISTRATION;
SURVEY ADMINISTRATION; QUALTRICS; R; SPSS; ZOTERO; DATA CLEANING AND VISUALIZATION

Technical

MICROSOFT WORD, EXCEL, POWERPOINT; ADOBE PHOTOSHOP

Language

WORKING KNOWLEDGE OF FRENCH

Additional Experience & Hobbies

Advanced yoga practitioner; extensive dance training across multiple styles.
Competitive swimmer for 10 years; varsity captain; All-American; school record holder; four-time state medalist.

REFERENCES

Dr. First Last

email@wfu.edu

PROFESSOR OF PSYCHOLOGY WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY RESEARCH SUPERVISOR